

12

Putting it all together

Investing in the stock market is a lot like getting into skincare. At the start you have no idea how it works. There's a lot of jargon that flies over your head. (What is 'slugging'?) You don't really grasp all the different strategies and regimes out there. (What order do you apply all these serums in?) You don't get how to integrate skincare routines into your life. (You want me to do *how* many steps before bed every night?) Then, as time goes on, you learn how it all operates and it starts to make sense.

You'll try a few products, make mistakes, find out what does and doesn't work for you, but eventually you get the hang of it. Then you'll start looking back and not understanding why it took you so long to start using sunscreen and retinol. (How could I have been so clueless?)

Investing in the stock market is no different. We all begin somewhere, often at zero. That doesn't mean that we have to stay there. Investing has never been more accessible; the only thing missing is the knowledge to bridge the gap.

Now let's take everything we've learned in the previous chapters in this book and put a plan together, step by step. If you haven't started yet, this will be perfect. If you have, this will still serve as a way to revitalise your portfolio and make sure you're on the right track. Skincare or investing, our routine can always be improved.

In this section, we'll get into the seven steps of getting started with investing:

Step #1: Unlearn those money mindsets

Step #2: Lay down those 5 bricks

Step #3: Work out your investing goals

Step #4: Work out your risk profile

Step #5: Work out your asset allocation